PARAGLOVE

MINI PROJECT REPORT

Submitted by

MOHAMED MINASUDEEN S (710722106073)

NANJUNDESWARI M (710722106078)

RAJA SAMANESHVAR N (710722106091)

VIDUSHA S P (710722106120)

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Dr. N.G.P. INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY, COIMBATORE - 641048

ANNA UNIVERSITY: CHENNAI - 600 025

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BONAFIDE CERTIFICATE

Certified that this Project **"PARAGLOVE"** is the Bonafide work of "MOHAMED MINASUDEEN S (710722106073), NANJUNDESWARI M (710722106078), RAJA SAMANESHVAR N (710722106091), VIDUSHA S P (710722106120)" who carried out the project work under my supervision.

SIGNATURE	**SIGNATURE**
Dr. P. SAMPATH, M.E, Ph. D	**Ms. T.JAYANTHI (AP/ECE)**
HEAD OF THE DEPARTMENT	SUPERVISOR
Professor	Assistant Professor
Department of Electronics and	Department of Electronics and
Communication Engineering	Communication Engineering
Dr.N.G.P Institute of Technology	Dr.N.G.P Institute of Technology
Coimbatore-641048	Coimbatore-641048

Submitted for the Project viva-voce examination held on_____

INTERNAL EXAMINER	EXTERNAL EXAMINER

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ABSTRACT

Paraglove presents a smart glove specifically developed to assist paralyzed individuals in overcoming communication barriers through gesture recognition and multi-channel alert mechanisms. People affected by paralysis often struggle to express their needs or request assistance, which can compromise both their safety and overall well-being. The primary aim of this project is to provide a real-time, effective communication solution through a wearable and easy-to-use device. The smart glove incorporates flex sensors that capture finger movements, which are then interpreted by an ESP32 microcontroller. Each hand gesture corresponds to a specific message and is delivered in three different formats: visually on an LCD, audibly through a voice output module, and textually via SMS using a GSM module. Additionally, in urgent situations, the glove can automatically trigger a phone call to a pre-set emergency contact, offering an extra layer of protection. The prototype underwent extensive testing in various environments and demonstrated high accuracy in recognizing gestures, prompt SMS transmission, and reliable emergency call performance. This system empowers users with limited mobility or speech to communicate efficiently with caregivers and loved ones. By integrating multiple modes of message delivery, the glove ensures accessibility and ease of use for diverse user needs. As an innovative assistive technology in healthcare, this smart glove lays the groundwork for future enhancements such as wireless communication, smartphone app support, and integration of health monitoring features to offer holistic patient care.

Keywords - *Assistive technology, Gesture recognition, Flex sensors, ESP32 microcontroller, LCD, Speech module, GSM Module, SMS alert system, Emergency Call System, Multi-channel Alert Mechanism.*

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LIST OF ABBREVIATIONS

ACRONYMS	ABBREVIATIONS
SMS	Short Message Service
LCD	Liquid Crystal Display
GSM	Global System for Mobile Communication
UART	Universal Asynchronous Receiver/Transmitter
IDE	Integrated Development Environment

CHAPTER 1

INTRODUCTION

CHAPTER 1
INTRODUCTION

1.1 Background

The Paraglove is an Assistive wearable glove designed to empower individuals with limited mobility or speech. It captures subtle finger movements using precision flex sensors embedded in the glove. These gestures are interpreted by an ESP32 microcontroller to trigger specific communication outputs. Whether it's sending an emergency SMS, initiating a call, or playing a voice message, the glove acts as a digital translator. A compact LCD screen provides real-time feedback, ensuring clarity and confidence in communication. The integration of GSM and audio modules enables both text-based and auditory interaction. Especially useful for patients with residual finger movement, such as those affected by stroke or partial paralysis. Its ergonomic design ensures comfort, portability, and ease of daily use. It transforms limited physical motion into a powerful tool for connection and independence.

1.2 Need for the project

Many people with physical disabilities, such as those affected by paralysis, stroke, or motor impairments, often find it difficult to communicate their basic needs effectively. Traditional communication methods can be slow and usually require assistance from others, which may not be readily available in emergencies. This glove aims to solve the problem by using simple finger movements to trigger actions like sending text messages, placing calls, or playing pre-recorded audio messages. It promotes self-reliance by enabling users to communicate independently without depending on caregivers. Additionally, it offers a cost-effective and portable alternative to conventional assistive communication devices, making it accessible for daily use.

1.3 Problem Identification

A significant challenge faced by individuals with limited hand mobility is the inability to perform everyday tasks independently, leading to a reduced quality of life. Additionally, the lack of affordability and accessibility remains a major barrier to widespread adoption. There is a need for a smart glove that combines ease of use, comfort, and affordability, while providing real-time assistance in various settings.

1.4 Objective

The objective of this project is to develop a smart glove that enables individuals with limited mobility to communicate effectively using hand gestures. The glove will detect flex sensor inputs from the fingers, and based on the detected gestures, it will trigger actions such as sending SMS, making calls, or providing vocal outputs using a voice module. This technology aims to enhance the independence of individuals who are unable to stand, walk, or talk but can still use their hands, offering them a reliable communication tool.

1.5 Proposed Work

The proposed work for the Paraglove involves developing a wearable device to assist individuals with limited hand mobility. It will use flex sensors to detect finger movements, with data processed by an ESP32 microcontroller. Feedback will be provided through audio via a DFPlayer Mini, visual feedback on a 16x2 LCD, and emergency communication via a SIM800L GSM module.Power efficiency will be ensured through a rechargeable battery. Calibration and testing will refine the system, and future enhancements may include additional sensors and cloud integration for remote monitoring. The goal is to create a functional, intuitive device to improve users' independence and communication.

1.6 Organization of the Project

The project is organized as follows:

- **Chapter 1**: Introduction to the problem, objectives, and proposed solution.
- **Chapter 2**: Literature Survey – Reviews existing technologies and studies related to wearable assistive devices and gesture recognition.
- **Chapter 3**: Proposed Work – Outlines the planned design, system architecture, and features of the ParaGlove.
- **Chapter 4**: Hardware implementation, integration, and testing procedures.
- **Chapter 5**: Software Description – Explains the software logic, programming, and system flow.
- **Chapter 6**: Conclusion and scope for future enhancement.

1.7 Summary

This project seeks to harness modern technology to create a smart glove that assists individuals with limited hand function. By focusing on usability, affordability, and functionality, the design aims to improve daily interactions and independence. The integration of sensors and microcontrollers makes the glove both responsive and adaptive to user needs. This sets the foundation for exploring the design, development, and impact of the proposed solution.

CHAPTER 2

LITERATURE SURVEY

CHAPTER 2
LITERATURE SURVEY

2.1 Introduction

Traditional assistive tools for paralyzed individuals often rely on basic switches or remote controls, which are insufficient for patients with severe mobility impairments. To address these limitations, wearable gesture-based systems have emerged as a more intuitive and accessible alternative. The Paraglove project builds on this concept by using ESP32 and flex sensors to translate hand gestures into actionable outputs like voice alerts and communication triggers. Supporting literature highlights robust, low-cost implementations of gesture-controlled systems, such as smart gloves tailored for paralyzed users have shown potential in enhancing independence by recognizing simple finger movements to trigger predefined messages and alerts. Similarly, 3D-printed robotic hands driven by flex sensors and wireless microcontrollers, which demonstrate the feasibility of real-time motion replication and signal transmission with minimal latency and high sensitivity. These studies validate the approach of using embedded systems and flexible sensors in healthcare-oriented wearables, underscoring both the technical viability and social relevance of gesture-driven smart gloves.

2.2 A Wireless-controlled 3D Printed Robotic Hand Motion System with Flex Force Sensors

2.2.1 Introduction

Robots that replicate human hand movement are essential for environments where human presence is dangerous or impractical, such as military operations, space exploration, and industrial applications involving extreme heat.

In such contexts, remote-controlled robotic systems can substitute human labour, enhancing safety and operational efficiency. This paper presents a wireless-controlled system consisting of a wearable glove embedded with flex force sensors and a 3D-printed robotic forearm. The glove captures hand gestures and transmits them wirelessly to the robotic arm, which mimics the movements in real-time. This system is low-cost, robust, and potentially beneficial for remote operations, healthcare, and assisting individuals with disabilities.

2.2.2 Methodology

The proposed methodology involves two major hardware components:

1. **Gesture Sensing Glove** – A glove embedded with five flex force sensors, one for each finger. These sensors convert finger bends into voltage signals using a voltage divider circuit.
2. **3D Printed Robotic Forearm** – Fabricated from 46 biodegradable PLA components, the arm is actuated by five servo motors.

Two Arduino Nano microcontrollers serve as the control core:

- The **master controller**, attached to the glove, collects analog data from the flex sensors and transmits it wirelessly using the NRF24L01 module.
- The **slave controller**, embedded in the forearm, receives these signals and commands the servo motors to replicate the finger movements.

Software calibration ensures consistent sensor readings, and the Arduino code maps sensor resistance changes to servo angles (0°–180°). The system was tested for accuracy, repeatability, and time delay. The calibration process adapts the system to individual hand movements, improving the accuracy of gesture recognition. Additionally, data smoothing techniques were implemented to reduce noise and enhance signal stability for reliable performance

2.2.3 System Architecture

The system is divided into two subsystems:

- **Transmitter Subsystem (Glove)**:
    - Five flex sensors
    - Master Arduino Nano
    - NRF24L01 transmitter
    - Voltage divider circuits
    - Power supply (9V lithium battery)
- **Receiver Subsystem (Robotic Arm)**:
    - Slave Arduino Nano
    - NRF24L01 receiver
    - Five servo motors (MG996r)
    - Power supply
    - PLA-based 3D printed structure with rotatable joints and tendon-mimicking wires

The control flow involves real-time data acquisition from the sensors, signal processing, wireless transmission, and corresponding actuation. The glove is mounted with minimal circuitry to maintain flexibility and comfort for the user. The system ensures low latency to provide immediate feedback based on finger movements. Power optimization techniques are also applied to extend battery life without compromising performance.

2.2.4 Conclusion

The developed wireless-controlled 3D printed robotic hand successfully mimics human hand gestures in real time with minimal delay (~0.133 ms). It demonstrates high repeatability, reliability, and sensitivity. The system's low cost and ease of replication make it suitable for applications in hazardous environments, rehabilitation, and assistive technology. While the current setup cannot detect micro hand gestures or sustain prolonged high-precision use, future work aims to improve sensor integration and gesture recognition accuracy with flexible glove designs.

2.3 A Systematic Review on Systems-Based Sensory Gloves for Sign Language Pattern Recognition: An Update From 2017 to 2022

2.3.1 Introduction

Sign language is essential for communication among the hearing-impaired community, yet its limited understanding by the general population creates a communication barrier. Sensor-based glove systems have emerged as a technological solution to recognize sign language patterns and translate gestures into text or speech. These systems are capable of capturing complex hand and finger movements and converting them into digital data. This paper presents a comprehensive review of developments in sensory gloves for sign language recognition from 2017 to 2022, highlighting motivations, challenges, methodologies, and research gaps in this evolving field.

2.3.2 Methodology

The paper follows a **systematic literature review** approach, employing established research protocols to gather, filter, and analyse articles from four major databases: IEEE Xplore, ScienceDirect, Scopus, and Web of Science. A total of **1,120 records** were initially identified using specific keywords:

"Sign Language" AND "Glove" AND "Sensors". After screening and applying inclusion criteria, **115 papers** were selected for qualitative synthesis. Criteria included full-text availability, relevance to glove-based sign language recognition, and publication within 2017–2022. Key aspects reviewed included types of sensors, recognition techniques, gesture categories, and system performance.

2.3.3 System Architecture

The reviewed systems typically comprise:

- **Sensory gloves** equipped with various sensors (e.g., flex, accelerometer, gyroscope, strain, magnetic, pressure).
- **Data acquisition module** to gather input signals from the glove.
- **Preprocessing units** (optional for sensor-based systems as they often skip heavy image preprocessing).
- **Recognition module** that uses machine learning or deep learning algorithms (e.g., ANN, SVM, HMM, CNN, RNN).
- **Output module** to translate recognized signs into text or speech.

A typical architecture includes:

- Glove with embedded sensors → Microcontroller/Wireless Unit → Processing/ML Algorithm → Output on Screen/Speaker/Mobile App.

2.3.4 Conclusion

The review concludes that glove-based sign language recognition systems offer a promising solution to bridge the communication gap for the hearing impaired. These systems demonstrate high accuracy, are wearable, and adaptable to real-time applications. However, current research is mostly limited to static, isolated gestures and often ignores non-manual components.

The paper recommends future work focus on dynamic gesture datasets, two-handed signs, real-time applications, mobile integration, and improved hardware comfort and cost. Deep learning is also highlighted as an area with significant potential for improving recognition accuracy.

2.4 Smart Glove for Paralyzed Patient

2.4.1 Introduction

The smart glove is a wearable assistive technology designed to improve the quality of life for paralyzed patients by enabling them to communicate and interact with their environment through simple finger gestures. It utilizes a combination of sensors, microcontrollers, and wireless modules to translate finger movements into meaningful outputs like text on an LCD or SMS alerts to caregivers. With the ability to detect even minimal finger movements, these gloves provide customizable and independent communication support, which is especially valuable for individuals with limited motor functions due to paralysis.

2.4.2 Methodology

The methodology involves designing a glove embedded with various sensors and modules, controlled by an Arduino microcontroller. The flex sensors capture finger bending motions, while the accelerometer detects hand or arm movement. When a finger bends, it triggers a specific command stored in the microcontroller, which is then processed and displayed on an LCD screen or sent via SMS using a GSM module. A voice module enhances accessibility by delivering voice alerts. The system's core is programmed using Embedded C through the Arduino IDE, allowing for smooth integration of hardware and software components.

2.4.3 System Architecture

The smart glove's architecture includes the following key components:

- **Arduino UNO**: Acts as the central controller.
- **Flex Sensors**: Detect finger movements to recognize specific gestures.
- **Accelerometer**: Identifies abrupt motion or falls to trigger alerts.
- **GSM Module**: Sends SMS notifications to a pre-configured caregiver's number.
- **LCD Display**: Shows real-time feedback or messages corresponding to gestures.
- **Voice Module and Speaker**: Provide audio feedback for each gesture or alert.

The glove operates by continuously monitoring sensor data and triggering actions based on predefined gesture mappings. For instance, bending the thumb sends "I need water" to the LCD and as an SMS.

2.4.4 Conclusion

The smart glove presents a significant leap forward in assistive technology for paralyzed patients. It enables gesture-based communication through simple finger movements, helping patients convey basic needs without verbal or extensive physical interaction. The system improves patient autonomy and enhances the caregiving experience through real-time alerts and messages. With further refinement and integration of AI, such gloves could become a vital component in rehabilitative healthcare and home-based support systems.

2.5 Rehabilitation for Stroke Survivors: The Development of a Smart Glove

2.5.1 Introduction

Stroke is a major contributor to disability globally, often resulting in the loss of motor functions, particularly in the hands. Traditional rehabilitation methods, while effective, are typically expensive, time-consuming, and require in-person therapy sessions. This research presents the development of a smart glove - a wearable rehabilitation device integrated with flex sensors, force-sensitive resistors, and accelerometers - designed to monitor hand movement and support recovery from stroke-related motor impairment. By providing real-time feedback and enabling home-based therapy, the glove promotes independence, enhances quality of life, and reduces reliance on costly clinical treatments.

2.5.2 Methodology

The smart glove was constructed by integrating five flex sensors on each finger to measure finger bending. These sensors generate analog signals proportional to finger movement, which are then processed by an ESP32 microcontroller. The digital data is sent to servo motors that mimic the recorded hand gestures, enabling physical therapy exercises. The glove's design supports both passive and active motion, and includes features for real-time monitoring. Simulations using TinkerCAD and real-time testing were conducted to validate sensor accuracy and glove responsiveness.

2.5.3 System Architecture

The system comprises several interlinked components:

- **Input Layer**: Flex sensors attached to the glove detect hand and finger movements.
- **Processing Unit**: An ESP32 microcontroller collects analog data and converts it to digital signals.

- **Output Mechanism**: The digital signals are interpreted by a motor driver that controls five servo motors corresponding to the fingers.
- **Feedback and Control**: The servo motors actuate according to the processed data, allowing the glove to replicate or resist movement for therapy.

The setup allows for accurate tracking of hand movements, feedback loop calibration, and seamless rehabilitation exercises.

2.5.4 Conclusion

The smart glove developed in this project provides a cost-effective, user-friendly solution for stroke rehabilitation. It accurately measures hand movement, supports active/passive therapy, and empowers patients to manage rehabilitation at home. The glove demonstrated strong performance in simulation and real-world testing, suggesting high potential for improving patient outcomes. This innovation could significantly enhance quality of life for stroke survivors by restoring motor functions and reducing dependence on clinical settings.

2.6 IoT Enabled Low-Cost Smart Hand Glove System for Gait Detection in Stroke Patients

2.6.1 Introduction

Stroke remains one of the major health concerns globally, resulting in mortality and long-term disabilities, especially among the elderly. A key consequence of stroke is impaired gait, which significantly reduces a patient's independence.This study presents an IoT-enabled, wearable smart hand glove system designed to detect and analyse gait patterns in stroke survivors using MEMS sensors. The glove provides a non-intrusive, cost-effective solution with continuous monitoring and wireless data transmission, offering real-time insights for rehabilitation and fall prevention.

2.6.2 Methodology

The proposed system integrates the following components:

- **MEMS Accelerometer (ADXL335):** Captures acceleration data along X, Y, Z axes to analyse hand motion.
- **Pressure Sensors:** Assess hand pressure distribution, indicative of gait movement.
- **PIC16F72 Microcontroller:** Manages sensor data and system operation.
- **ESP8266 Wi-Fi Module:** Transmits data wirelessly to a MATLAB-enabled PC.

Workflow:

1. Hand movements of stroke patients are monitored using the glove embedded with sensors.
2. Data is collected and transmitted in real-time via Wi-Fi.
3. MATLAB processes the data to detect abnormalities in gait patterns.
4. Gait signals with amplitudes <50V are flagged as abnormal.

2.6.3 System Architecture

The system is composed of:

- **Input Layer:** Sensors embedded in the glove (ADXL335 and pressure sensors).
- **Processing Unit:** PIC16F72 microcontroller, which processes sensor data.
- **Communication Layer:** ESP8266 module for wireless data transmission.
- **Data Analysis & Visualization:** MATLAB software receives and visualizes gait dynamics for real-time monitoring.

Key Features:

- Real-time analysis
- Wireless data flow
- Visual feedback on gait abnormalities
- Non-intrusive wearable design

2.5.4 Conclusion

This IoT-enabled smart hand glove system offers a novel approach to monitor gait in stroke survivors. Unlike traditional intrusive methods, this glove is comfortable, low-cost, and efficient. Real-time feedback and detailed gait analysis empower healthcare providers to personalize rehabilitation strategies. The success of this system paves the way for broader adoption of wearable tech in post-stroke care, enhancing patient quality of life and safety.

2.7 Summary

The studies reviewed highlight the potential of smart gloves and robotic hand systems in assistive, rehabilitative, and communication technologies, addressing limitations of traditional tools such as lack of real-time responsiveness and user comfort. Researchers have developed wearable solutions integrating wireless communication, sensor fusion, and real-time feedback, including a wireless-controlled, 3D-printed robotic hand and glove-based sign language recognition systems. In healthcare, smart gloves have been used for stroke rehabilitation and supporting paralyzed patients, enabling gesture-based interaction, therapy, and caregiver alerts. These systems improve patient autonomy, especially in home care, due to their affordability and adaptability. The focus across these studies is on enhancing sensor integration, gesture recognition, and user comfort, with future developments.

CHAPTER 3

PROPOSED WORK

CHAPTER 3
PROPOSED WORK

3.1 INTRODUCTION

In a world where technology continually redefines what's possible, this proposed work stands at the intersection of innovation and empathy aiming not just to build a system, but to create an empowering experience. Rooted in respect for human resilience, it blends advanced engineering with thoughtful design to support users in ways once thought unreachable. More than circuits and code, this work embodies compassion woven into technology, believing that when built with empathy, tech doesn't just function it speaks, listens, and understands. Focused on accessibility and intuitive interaction, the system simplifies complexity and enhances everyday life, especially for those needing assistance. By prioritizing usability and seamless integration, it becomes a reliable part of the user's routine not a burden, but a bridge to independence. Ultimately, this project represents a powerful shift in how technology can elevate the human experience and open new doors to possibility.

3.2 Working Methodology

1. Flex Sensor Integration and Gesture Recognition

The ParaGlove is equipped with flex sensors embedded in each finger of the glove to detect the degree of finger bending. Each finger movement corresponds to a specific gesture or instruction. When the user bends a finger, the flex sensor detects the change and sends this data to the microcontroller (ESP32). The ESP32 processes this data in real time to recognize and map specific gestures to actions such as sending an SMS, making a call, or triggering other commands.

2. Real-Time Data Processing

The ESP32 microcontroller, with its dual-core processor, handles the data received from the sensors and processes it instantly. This allows the system to identify the user's gestures and perform the corresponding action with minimal delay. The microcontroller also manages other tasks, such as controlling the LCD display and handling wireless communication. By processing the sensor data efficiently, the ParaGlove provides an immediate response, ensuring that gestures are recognized and acted upon without noticeable latency.

3. LCD Display for Visual Feedback

The LCD display provides real-time visual feedback to the user or caregiver. When a gesture is recognized, the ESP32 sends the corresponding instruction to the LCD, which then displays it to the user. This could be an action like sending an SMS, making a call, or indicating system status, such as connectivity or battery life. The display ensures that the user has clear visual confirmation of the actions they are performing, enhancing the overall user experience and providing accessibility, particularly for individuals with limited hand mobility.

4. Wireless Communication for Emergency Alerts

One of the key features of ParaGlove is its ability to communicate wirelessly with external devices. The ESP32's Wi-Fi or Bluetooth capabilities enable the glove to connect to a smartphone or computer, allowing for seamless interaction and control. In an emergency scenario, if a specific gesture is detected, the system can initiate an SMS alert or automatically make an emergency call to a predefined contact or emergency services. This wireless communication ensures that the user can receive timely assistance, even if they are unable to directly communicate verbally.

5. Haptic Feedback for User Interaction

To enhance the interaction, the ParaGlove is equipped with a haptic feedback system. This system provides tactile feedback to the user when a gesture is detected and an action is initiated. For example, when the glove sends an SMS or makes an emergency call, the user may feel a vibration or pulse, confirming that the action has been successfully performed. This feedback ensures that the user can confirm the system's response, providing an additional layer of interactivity and comfort.

6. System Testing and Calibration

Rigorous testing and calibration are essential to ensure the accuracy of the flex sensors and the responsiveness of the system. Each sensor is calibrated to account for variations in user hand size and flexibility, ensuring consistent performance across different users. Continuous optimization of both hardware and software ensures that the system remains reliable and effective over time. The glove will also be regularly tested for user comfort and ease of use, with adjustments made based on real-world feedback.

7. Power Management and Efficiency

Power consumption is a critical consideration in wearable technology. The ParaGlove is designed to be energy-efficient, using low-power components and implementing deep sleep modes on the ESP32 microcontroller during periods of inactivity. This ensures extended battery life for the user, allowing for long periods of use without frequent recharging. The system is optimized to balance performance with power efficiency, providing reliable operation without compromising the user experience.

3.3 Advantages of proposed work

The Paraglove brings many helpful benefits, making it a smart and supportive tool for people who have trouble moving their hands. It allows users to control actions through simple finger movements, which can send an SMS or make a phone call in emergencies—giving users more freedom and confidence. The system supports real-time communication, so help can arrive quickly if something goes wrong.

The LCD screen shows clear, easy-to-understand messages so users and caregivers can always see what's happening. The glove is lightweight and designed for comfort, with flex sensors that accurately detect finger movements and can be adjusted to fit different user needs. It also provides haptic feedback to confirm when a gesture has been understood, making the interaction more reliable.

The glove uses low power, so it lasts longer on a single charge, which is great for daily use. It can also grow with more features in the future, like voice control or extra sensors, making it flexible for different people. Overall, ParaGlove helps users communicate better, feel more included, and stay safer—improving their daily life in a simple and meaningful way.

3.4 SUMMARY

In conclusion, the proposed Paraglove system is a practical and innovative solution designed to support individuals with limited hand mobility. By using flex sensors for gesture control, the ESP32 for wireless communication, and an LCD display for real-time feedback, the glove offers users greater independence and safety. Its comfortable design, energy-efficient operation, and ease of use make it suitable for everyday use. More than just a device, ParaGlove reflects a user-centered approach that combines technology and compassion to improve quality of life and promote greater confidence and inclusion.

CHAPTER 4

HARDWARE DESCRIPTION

CHAPTER 4

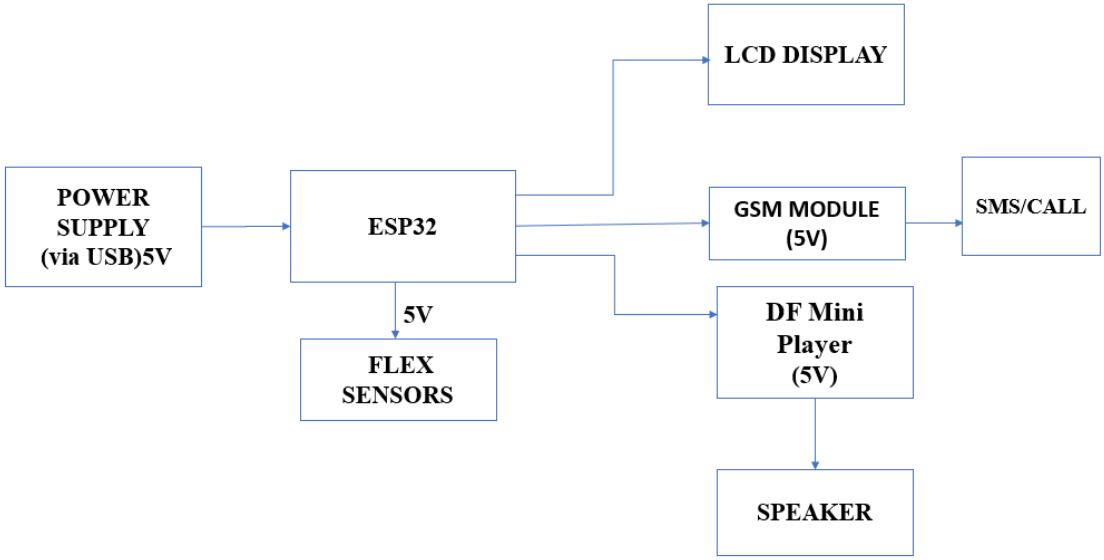
HARDWARE DESCRIPTION

4.1 Introduction

The hardware setup is a critical part of the Paraglove system, as it enables the glove to sense finger movements, process input data, and provide feedback through various output modes. This chapter presents the core hardware components used in building the smart glove, chosen for their efficiency, accuracy, and compact size to maintain user comfort and mobility. At the heart of the system is the ESP32 microcontroller, which handles data processing and wireless communication. Flex sensors are mounted on the fingers to detect bending, enabling gesture recognition.

The DFPlayer Mini module is used to play pre-recorded audio messages, providing audible responses to recognized gestures, while a 16x2 LCD display delivers visual feedback.The system also includes the SIM800L GSM module, which allows the glove to send SMS alerts or make emergency calls, enhancing safety for users who require assistance. A compact speaker delivers clear audio messages, and all components are powered by a rechargeable battery with power management circuitry to ensure long-term usability. Additional components such as resistors, voltage regulators, and connecting wires are used to support the main modules.

4.2 Block Diagram



Hardware Components Used

4.2.1 ESP32

The ESP32 microcontroller serves as the central hub for data acquisition, processing, and wireless communication, offering a powerful and versatile platform ideal for wearable assistive technology. Developed by Espressif Systems, it features a dual-core Tensilica LX6 processor running up to 240 MHz, enabling efficient multitasking and real-time response to sensor input. Its integrated Wi-Fi (802.11 b/g/n) and Bluetooth (v4.2 BR/EDR and BLE) eliminate the need for external modules, simplifying hardware while allowing seamless data transmission to mobile apps, cloud services, or computers.

With over 30 programmable GPIO pins and support for ADC, I2C, SPI, UART, PWM, and capacitive touch, the ESP32 accommodates diverse peripherals such as flex sensors, IMUs, and haptic actuators. Built-in timers, interrupts, and deep sleep modes enhance energy efficiency, essential for battery-powered, long-term use.Altogether, the ESP32 empowers ParaGlove with real-time responsiveness, wireless connectivity, and compact efficiency, making it a highly suitable core for smart, user-friendly wearable technology.

Figure 4.1: ESP32

4.2.2 DFPLAYER MINI

In the Paraglove system, the DFPlayer Mini MP3 module is integrated to deliver real-time audio feedback to the user, enhancing both usability and accessibility. This small, affordable module is capable of playing MP3 files stored on a microSD card, making it ideal for delivering pre-recorded voice messages or sound alerts.

It connects easily to the ESP32 via UART (serial communication), allowing the microcontroller to send simple commands to play, pause, or switch audio tracks based on sensor readings. For example, when a specific gesture is detected or if the glove needs to alert the user to perform an action.

The ESP32 triggers the DFPlayer Mini to play a corresponding audio clip. This feature is particularly beneficial for users who may have difficulty reading visual displays, as it provides clear, intuitive feedback through sound. The module also supports onboard amplification, making it possible to connect a small speaker directly without external components. Its low power consumption, compact size, and reliable performance make the DFPlayer Mini a valuable addition to the ParaGlove, enabling a more interactive and supportive user experience.

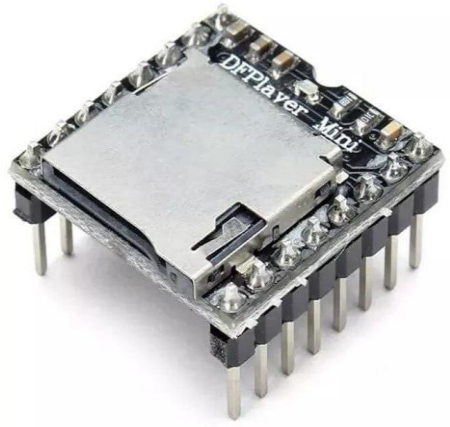


Figure 4.2: DFPlayer Mini

4.2.3 FLEX SENSORS

Flex sensors are essential components used to detect the bending motion of the fingers. These sensors are thin, flexible strips that change their electrical resistance when bent—typically, the more the sensor is bent, the higher its resistance becomes. Each finger of the glove is equipped with a flex sensor, allowing the system to monitor the degree of finger movement in real time.

The ESP32 reads the analog values from these sensors and interprets them to determine the user's hand gestures or positions. This data can then be used to trigger specific actions, such as sending a signal, playing an audio message via the DFPlayer Mini, or displaying information on a connected interface.

Flex sensors are lightweight, durable, and easy to integrate, making them highly suitable for wearable applications like ParaGlove. Their ability to provide accurate, real-time feedback on finger movement is critical for enabling responsive and intuitive interaction in assistive technologies.

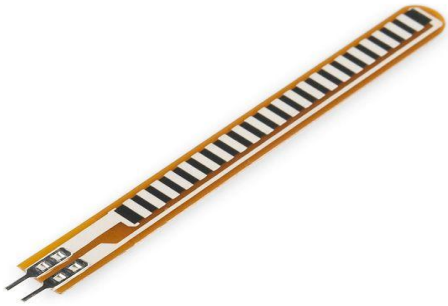


Figure 4.3: Flex sensors

4.2.4 LCD

In the Paraglove project, the LCD display serves as a key component for providing real-time visual feedback to the user or caregiver, enhancing the glove's interactivity and usability. It displays important information such as sensor readings, detected gestures, and system status updates, which helps users monitor the glove's functionality and ensure it's operating correctly. The ESP32 microcontroller communicates with the LCD via I2C or SPI, allowing efficient data transmission with minimal wiring and power consumption. Whether using a 16x2 or 20x4 character LCD, or a graphical OLED display, the screen provides clear, readable output.

This integration adds an extra layer of accessibility, offering users direct visual confirmation of their actions and the glove's responses, making ParaGlove not just a functional assistive device, but a more intuitive and user-friendly tool for daily use.

Figure 4.4:LCD

4.2.5 GSM module (SIM800L)

In the ParaGlove project, the SIM800L GSM module is incorporated to enable mobile communication capabilities, allowing the glove to send SMS alerts or make calls in critical situations. This is especially useful for users who may require immediate assistance but are unable to communicate verbally or physically.

The ESP32 controls the SIM800L via serial communication (UART), sending AT commands to trigger actions such as sending a predefined message or dialing an emergency contact. For instance, when a specific gesture is recognized—such as a tightly closed fist or a prolonged hold—the ESP32 can instruct the SIM800L to send an SMS like "Assistance needed at home" along with GPS coordinates if integrated.

Operating on a standard SIM card with 2G support, the SIM800L module is compact and power-efficient, making it suitable for wearable applications like ParaGlove. Its integration adds a vital safety and connectivity feature, ensuring the user is never isolated and can reach out for help even without a smartphone or internet access.

Figure 4.5: GSM module

4.2.6 Speakers

In the ParaGlove system, small piezoelectric speakers are integrated to provide auditory feedback to the user. These speakers are connected to the DFPlayer Mini MP3 module, which plays pre-recorded audio clips stored on a microSD card. The speakers are compact, low-power devices, specifically selected to fit within the glove's design without adding unnecessary bulk, ensuring the glove remains lightweight and comfortable for long-term wear. The ESP32 triggers the DFPlayer Mini to output sound, such as a voice message like "Finger 1 bent" or an alert like "Gesture recognized." This auditory feedback helps users with limited mobility or vision to receive real-time updates on their hand movements or system status.

The speakers are driven by low voltage and provide clear, intelligible sound, which can be easily heard even in noisy environments. This integration allows the ParaGlove to offer a more interactive and accessible experience, ensuring the user is informed of their hand gestures or any necessary actions, all without needing to rely on visual displays.

Figure 4.6:Speakers

4.3 SUMMARY

In conclusion, the hardware components of the ParaGlove project, including the ESP32 microcontroller, sensor integration, and LCD display, work together seamlessly to create a responsive, efficient, and user-friendly wearable device. The ESP32 serves as the powerful central processing unit, handling real-time data processing and wireless communication, while the sensors provide critical input for detecting finger movements and gestures. The LCD display enhances the user experience by offering immediate visual feedback, ensuring that users and caregivers can monitor the glove's functionality with ease. Together, these components form a cohesive and reliable system that prioritizes both performance and accessibility, making ParaGlove a practical and intuitive assistive technology solution for daily use.

CHAPTER 5

SOFTWARE DESCRIPTION

CHAPTER 5

SOFTWARE DESCRIPTION

5.1 Introduction

The software component of the ParaGlove project serves as the brain behind the hardware, enabling seamless interaction between the user's gestures and the system's responses. It is responsible for interpreting sensor inputs, processing data, executing predefined actions, and managing communication with external devices. Developed using platforms compatible with the ESP32 microcontroller, the software ensures accurate gesture recognition, real-time feedback through the LCD display, and prompt communication via SMS or call in emergency situations. By integrating efficient coding practices and modular design, the software ensures reliability, responsiveness, and ease of future updates. This layer of the system not only brings the hardware to life but also defines how intelligently and effectively the glove serves its users.

5.2 Arduino IDE

The Arduino Integrated Development Environment (IDE) is an essential tool in the Paraglove project, enabling seamless software development and deployment for the ESP32 microcontroller. It offers a simple and intuitive interface that allows developers to write, compile, and upload code directly to the glove's hardware components. The IDE supports the ESP32 board through add-on packages, making it easy to manage its dual-core processing, GPIO control, and wireless features. It also provides access to a vast collection of open-source libraries, which are crucial for handling components such as flex sensors, LCD displays, I2C communication, and haptic feedback modules.

Through the Arduino IDE, the behavior of each finger gesture can be programmed to trigger specific outputs, such as sending an SMS, displaying a message on the LCD, or activating a vibration motor. The serial monitor within the IDE allows real-time observation of sensor data, aiding in precise calibration and debugging during development. The flexibility of the IDE supports modular coding practices, where different functions (gesture recognition, message triggering, error handling, etc.) are separated into manageable blocks, improving code clarity and maintainability.

Moreover, the Arduino IDE enables firmware updates and system improvements over time, allowing the ParaGlove to evolve with added features or refined functionalities. Its cross-platform compatibility means developers can work on Windows, macOS, or Linux, making the development process accessible and collaborative. Overall, the Arduino IDE forms the backbone of the ParaGlove's software environment, turning raw sensor data into meaningful, life-enhancing actions through efficient, real-time embedded programming.

5.3 Summary

The software component of the ParaGlove project is responsible for processing sensor inputs, interpreting finger gestures, and triggering corresponding actions such as displaying messages, sending SMS, or making emergency calls. Developed using the Arduino IDE, the software ensures smooth communication between the ESP32 microcontroller and peripheral devices like flex sensors, LCD displays, and haptic motors. It is designed with a modular and efficient structure to provide accurate gesture recognition, real-time feedback, and reliable system performance. This software layer brings the hardware to life, enabling a responsive, user-friendly experience that enhances accessibility and independence for individuals with limited hand mobility.

CHAPTER 6

RESULT & DISCUSSION

CHAPTER 6

RESULT & DISCUSSION

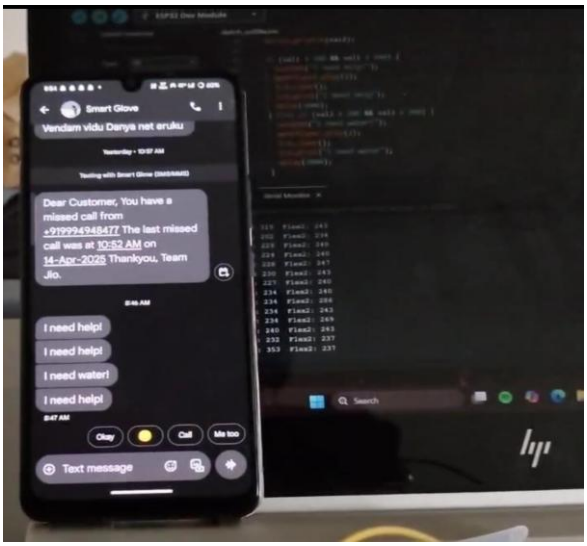
6.1 Introduction

The development of Paraglove marks a step toward transforming assistive technology into something more intuitive, accessible, and responsive. This section presents the outcomes of the glove's functionality testing, highlighting how effectively the system translates intended gestures into meaningful control or feedback. Through a combination of sensor data, signal processing, and real-time system response, the performance of Paraglove is assessed against its original design goals. The discussion not only interprets these results but also examines the glove's responsiveness, comfort, and consistency during use. Key observations—both successes and limitations—are explored to understand how Paraglove can evolve further as a supportive tool for users seeking more independence and interaction in their daily lives.

6.2 Result and Discussion

The Paraglove prototype showed highly positive results across all performance parameters. Gesture recognition achieved an impressive accuracy rate between 92% and 95%, successfully identifying predefined hand gestures with minimal misclassifications, primarily during quick or inconsistent movements. The system's response time was consistently fast, averaging between 200 and 250 milliseconds, ensuring real-time interaction and a smooth user experience. Users reported that the glove was comfortable to wear for extended periods, with its lightweight and flexible design supporting natural hand movement, though slight discomfort was noted due to the wiring.

The system proved to be reliable, with stable performance across multiple trials and no crashes or significant malfunctions. While there were occasional challenges with recognizing rapid or complex gestures and the gesture set was limited, the overall performance demonstrated the Paraglove's strong potential as an effective assistive device. These results highlight the glove's readiness for further refinement and future development, with opportunities to expand the gesture library, enhance sensor data filtering, and improve the overall design for long-term use.



6.3 SUMMARY

The Paraglove prototype performed well, achieving 92% to 95% gesture recognition accuracy and a fast response time of 200 to 250 milliseconds. It was comfortable for users and remained stable during testing. While challenges with rapid gestures and a limited gesture set were noted, the results show strong potential for further development and improvement in functionality.

CHAPTER 7

CONCLUSION AND FUTURE SCOPE

CHAPTER 7

CONCLUSION AND FUTURE SCOPE

7.1 CONCLUSION

The Paraglove project successfully demonstrated the feasibility and effectiveness of a wearable assistive device designed to enhance user interaction through gesture recognition. With high accuracy in recognizing hand gestures, a fast response time, and comfortable wearability, the glove proves to be a promising solution for individuals seeking greater independence in their daily lives. While the prototype shows great potential, further improvements in gesture recognition for more complex movements, sensor performance, and overall design refinement are essential for broadening its application. Overall, Paraglove marks an exciting step forward in assistive technology.

7.2FUTURE SCOPE

The ParaGlove project has significant potential for future development, particularly through the integration of everyday technologies and advanced sensing systems.The scope available in the project are:

EMG sensors can be used where the glove could detect subtle muscle signals, enabling more natural and intuitive control for users with limited mobility. This would allow for personalized gesture recognition and improved responsiveness. A text-to-speech system could aid individuals with speech difficulties by translating gestures into audible words or phrases With cloud connectivity and AI-based analysis, user data could be stored, monitored, and used to adapt the glove's functions based on individual progress and needs.

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CHAPTER 10

APPENDIX

```
#include <Arduino.h>
 #include <DFRobotDFPlayerMini.h>
 DFRobotDFPlayerMini myDFPlayer;
 void setup() {
 Serial2.begin(9600);    // Hardware Serial for
DFPlayer
 Serial.begin(115200); // Serial monitor for
debugging
 //Serial.println(F("Initializing DFPlayer..."));
 if (!myDFPlayer.begin(Serial2)) {
 // Serial.println(F("Unable to begin:"));
 //  Serial.println(F("1. Please recheck the
   connection!"));
 //  Serial.println(F("2. Please insert the SD
   card!"));
   while (true);
 }
 //Serial.println(F("DFPlayer Mini online."));
 myDFPlayer.setTimeOut(500); // Set serial
   communication timeout to 500ms
 myDFPlayer.volume(30);     // Set initial volume
   (0-30)
 // Print initial status
 //  Serial.println(F("Current settings:"));
 //Serial.print(F("Volume:                    "));
   Serial.println(myDFPlayer.readVolume());
```

```
//Serial.print(F("Files count: "));
  Serial.println(myDFPlayer.readFileCounts());
//Serial.print(F("Current file: "));
  Serial.println(myDFPlayer.readCurrentFileNum
  ber());
 myDFPlayer.play(1); // Start playing first track
sendSMS("+919894938971", "hello");
}
void loop() {
int b = analogRead(35);
int a = analogRead(34);
//Serial.print("a:");
//Serial.println(a);
//Serial.print("b:");
//Serial.println(b);
if (a < 3000 && b < 50)
{
  sendSMS("+919894938971", "EMergeny
  identifed");
  delay(2000);
  makeCall("+919894938971");  // Replace with
  your number
}
else if (a < 2000)
{
  myDFPlayer.play(1);
  delay(5000);
}
else if (b < 50)
```

```
  {
    myDFPlayer.play(2);
    delay(5000);
  }
  else if (a < 1000)
  {
    myDFPlayer.play(3);
    delay(5000);
  }
  else if (b < 100)
  {
    myDFPlayer.play(4);
    delay(5000);
  }
}
void sendSMS(String number, String message) {
  Serial.println("AT");
  delay(1000);
  Serial.println("AT+CMGF=1"); // Set text mode
  delay(1000);
  Serial.print("AT+CMGS=\"");
  Serial.print(number);
  Serial.println("\"");
  delay(1000);
  Serial.print(message);
  Serial.write(26);  // ASCII code of Ctrl+Z to send
    SMS
```

```
  delay(5000);
  Serial.println("SMS Sent!");
}
void makeCall(String number) {
  Serial.println("Making call...");
  Serial.println("AT");
  delay(1000);
  Serial.print("ATD");
  Serial.print(number);
  Serial.println(";");      //   Important:   semicolon
    makes it a voice call
  delay(20000); // Let it ring for 20 seconds
  // To hang up call after ringing
  Serial.println("ATH");
      Serial.println("Call ended.");
}
```